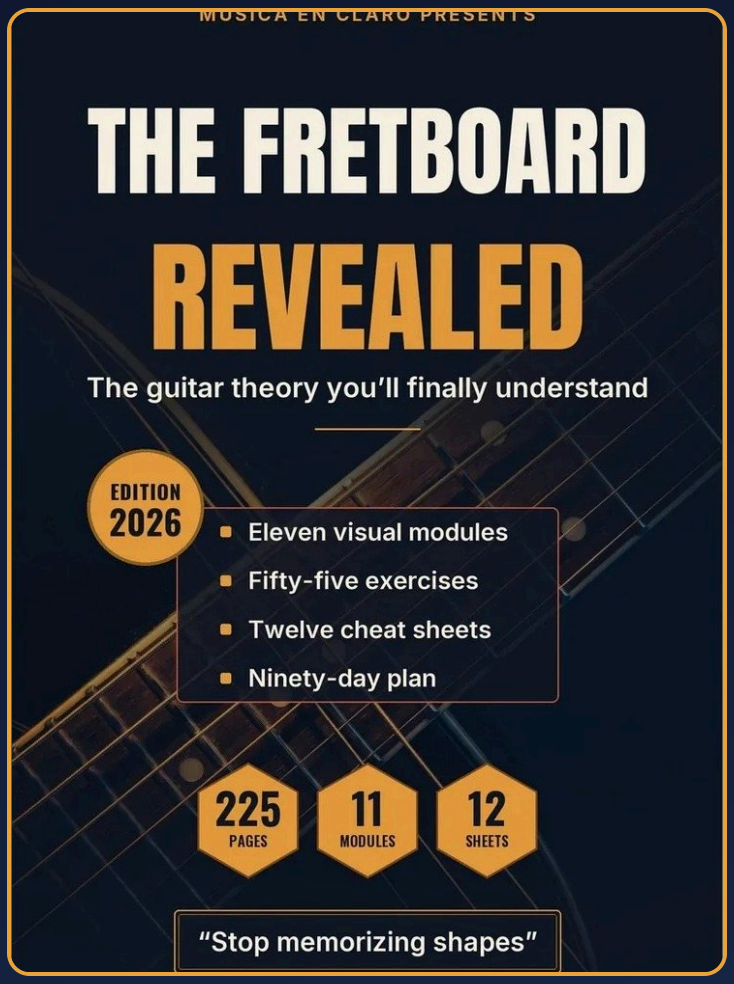
BONUS 3

100 Progressions

By genre and by mood, each in C and in G



How to use the 100 progressions

Every progression is written as **Roman numerals** (the chord function) and then spelled out in two keys: **C** and **G**. Uppercase numerals are major chords, lowercase are minor, and suffixes like 7, maj7 or sus4 add color. To play a progression in any other key, keep the numbers and swap the key.

NUMERAL	IN C	IN G	TYPE
I	C	G	major
ii	Dm	Am	minor
iii	Em	Bm	minor
IV	F	C	major
V	G	D	major
vi	Am	Em	minor
vii dim	Bdim	F#dim	diminished
bVII	Bb	F	borrowed major

> **Three ways to practice**
>
> 1) Play it slowly with one chord per bar. 2) Change the strumming feel to match the genre. 3) Move it to a third key using the number system or a capo.

Pop: 10 progressions

#1 The Four-Chord Anthem

I - V - vi - IV

C: C - G - Am - F
G: G - D - Em - C

uplifting | nostalgic

The most familiar pop loop: bright, open and instantly singable. It carries choruses and sing-alongs in countless styles.

Try: Strum steady eighth notes and accent beats 2 and 4 to keep it lively.

#2 Minor Start Lift

vi - IV - I - V

C: Am - F - C - G
G: Em - C - G - D

bittersweet | uplifting

Starting on the relative minor gives a wistful verse that blooms into a bright resolution. Common in emotional pop choruses.

Try: Let the vi ring a little longer before you change to IV.

#3 Fifties Turnaround

I - vi - IV - V

C: C - Am - F - G
G: G - Em - C - D

nostalgic | warm

A classic doo-wop style cycle with a retro glow. It sounds sweet and gentle at slow to medium tempos.

Try: Try a swung triplet strum to bring out the vintage feel.

#4 Gentle Climb

I - IV - vi - V

C: C - F - Am - G
G: G - C - Em - D

warm | romantic

Moves up through the major scale family before the V pulls back home. Works for soft verses and pre-choruses.

Try: Switch to a light fingerpicked pattern on the V to build lift.

#5 Sunny Walk-Up

I - iii - IV - V

C: C - Em - F - G
G: G - Bm - C - D

playful | uplifting

The iii adds a touch of color before the IV and V push forward. Bouncy and cheerful.

Try: Keep the strum short and crisp to match the playful energy.

#6 Chorus Opener

IV - I - V - vi

C: F - C - G - Am
G: C - G - D - Em

triumphant | uplifting

Starting on IV makes the chorus feel like it is lifting off. Great for big, open sections.

Try: Strum full downstrokes on the first chord of each bar for impact.

#7 Five-Chord Flow

I - V - vi - iii - IV

C: C - G - Am - Em - F
G: G - D - Em - Bm - C

dreamy | nostalgic

The extra iii creates a longer, flowing arc that feels like drifting through memories.

Try: Practice the vi to iii change slowly, it is the trickiest move.

#8 Minor Lean

vi - V - IV - V

C: Am - G - F - G
G: Em - D - C - D

melancholic | driving

Hovers in the minor zone and rocks between IV and V. Suits driving, moody pop verses.

Try: Palm-mute the verse and open up on the chorus for contrast.

#9 Maj7 Shimmer

I - IVmaj7 - vi - V

C: C - Fmaj7 - Am - G
G: G - Cmaj7 - Em - D

dreamy romantic

The maj7 on IV adds a soft, glassy sheen. Typical of mellow modern pop.

Try: Let the chords ring out and use light arpeggios.

#10 Open Add9 Glow

Iadd9 - V - vi7 - IVmaj7

C: Cadd9 - G - Am7 - Fmaj7
G: Gadd9 - D - Em7 - Cmaj7

dreamy warm

Open, airy voicings make a lush bedroom pop sound with plenty of space.

Try: Keep your top strings ringing to hold the shimmer across all four chords.

Rock: 10 progressions

#11 Mixolydian Drive

I - bVII - IV - I

C: C - Bb - F - C
G: G - F - C - G

driving triumphant

The flat seven gives a swaggering, bluesy rock sound found in stadium anthems.

Try: Use power chords with palm muting and let the IV ring.

#12 Three-Chord Stomp

I - IV - V - IV

C: C - F - G - F
G: G - C - D - C

driving playful

A back-and-forth riff built on strong open chords. It is the backbone of garage and classic rock.

Try: Down-pick steadily and lean on beat 1 of every bar.

#13 Dark Descent

i - bVII - bVI - bVII

C: Cm - Bb - Ab - Bb
G: Gm - F - Eb - F

dark driving

A heavy minor loop with a rolling bass motion. Often used in hard rock and metal verses.

Try: Try alternate picking on the low strings for a tight sound.

#14 Major-Third Crunch

I - bIII - IV - I

C: C - Eb - F - C
G: G - Bb - C - G

triumphant driving

The borrowed bIII chord adds punch and attitude. Sounds like a classic rock chorus.

Try: Slide into the bIII from a fret away for extra grit.

#15 Epic Minor Climb

i - bVI - bIII - bVII

C: Cm - Ab - Eb - Bb
G: Gm - Eb - Bb - F

dark triumphant

A cinematic minor progression that rises like a big riff. Suits epic rock and alt-rock choruses.

Try: Build intensity by adding distortion on the bVI.

#16 Simple Slam

I - V - IV

C: C - G - F
G: G - D - C

driving playful

Just three chords but huge energy. Perfect for fast punk-leaning songs.

Try: Play fast downstrokes only, no upstrokes, for punk bite.

#17 Flat Seven Swagger

I - bVII - IV

C: C - Bb - F
G: G - F - C

relaxed driving

A loose, rolling groove that sits comfortably in the pocket of a rock band.

Try: Leave a tiny gap after each chord to make it groove.

#18 Minor Fourth Edge

i - iv - bVII - bIII

C: Cm - Fm - Bb - Eb
G: Gm - Cm - F - Bb

dark mysterious

A moody minor sequence with a strong bass pull. Great for brooding verses.

Try: Keep the strum tight and consistent, with accents on 2 and 4.

#19 Rock Ladder

I - IV - bVII - IV

C: C - F - Bb - F
G: G - C - F - C

driving warm

The bVII acts as a bridge between IV and back, giving the classic 70s rock feel.

Try: Mix open chords with a quick hammer-on for flavor.

#20 Double Flat Lift

I - bVI - bVII - I

C: C - Ab - Bb - C
G: G - Eb - F - G

triumphant driving

Two borrowed chords rise toward the tonic with an arena-ready finale.

Try: Hold the final I and let it ring for dramatic effect.

Blues: 10 progressions

#21 Quick Skeleton

I7 - IV7 - I7 - V7

C: C7 - F7 - C7 - G7
G: G7 - C7 - G7 - D7

relaxed · driving

The four-chord skeleton of the twelve-bar blues. Dirty, direct and instantly bluesy.

Try: Use a shuffle rhythm with a long-short feel.

#22 Quick-Change Twelve-Bar

I7 - IV7 - I7 - IV7 - I7 - V7 - IV7 - I7

C: C7 - F7 - C7 - F7 - C7 - G7 - F7 - C7
G: G7 - C7 - G7 - C7 - G7 - D7 - C7 - G7

driving · warm

A condensed twelve-bar blues with the early move to IV7. The standard of blues jams worldwide.

Try: Count four bars on I7 then listen for the changes.

#23 Minor Twelve-Bar

i7 - iv7 - i7 - V7 - iv7 - i7 - V7 - i7

C: Cm7 - Fm7 - Cm7 - G7 - Fm7 - Cm7 - G7 - Cm7
G: Gm7 - Cm7 - Gm7 - D7 - Cm7 - Gm7 - D7 - Gm7

dark · melancholic

The minor blues form, moody and smoky with a dominant V7 turnaround.

Try: Add a slow vibrato on the minor third for expression.

#24 Short Form

I7 - IV7 - I7 - V7 - IV7 - I7

C: C7 - F7 - C7 - G7 - F7 - C7
G: G7 - C7 - G7 - D7 - C7 - G7

relaxed · warm

A six-chord reduction of the twelve-bar blues that keeps all of the character.

Try: Play it first with just downstrokes at a slow tempo.

#25 Three-Chord Boogie

I7 - IV7 - V7

C: C7 - F7 - G7
G: G7 - C7 - D7

playful · driving

The bare essentials of blues: three dominant chords that make everything swing.

Try: Add a boogie bass pattern in the bass strings.

#26 Slow Burn Blues

I7 - IV7 - I7 - V7 - IV7 - I7 - I7 - V7

C: C7 - F7 - C7 - G7 - F7 - C7 - C7 - G7
G: G7 - C7 - G7 - D7 - C7 - G7 - G7 - D7

bittersweet · relaxed

A slow twelve-bar with a spacious feel. Leaves lots of room for vocal phrases.

Try: Play fewer notes and leave space between licks.

#27 Jazz Blues Form

I7 - IV7 - I7 - vi7 - ii7 - V7 - I7 - V7

C: C7 - F7 - C7 - Am7 - Dm7 - G7 - C7 - G7
G: G7 - C7 - G7 - Em7 - Am7 - D7 - G7 - D7

playful · warm

A jazzier blues where the second half uses a ii V turnaround. Smooth and sophisticated.

Try: Practice the vi7 ii7 V7 as a block before adding the rest.

#28 Eight-Bar Blues

I7 - V7 - IV7 - IV7 - I7 - V7 - I7

C: C7 - G7 - F7 - F7 - C7 - G7 - C7
G: G7 - D7 - C7 - C7 - G7 - D7 - G7

relaxed · nostalgic

A compact eight-bar blues used in classic songs. Feels punchy and direct.

Try: Count eight bars and aim to land the V7 on bar six.

#29 Slow Shuffle Twelve

I7 - IV7 - I7 - I7 - IV7 - IV7 - I7 - V7

C: C7 - F7 - C7 - C7 - F7 - F7 - C7 - G7
G: G7 - C7 - G7 - G7 - C7 - C7 - G7 - D7

relaxed warm

Stays on the I7 longer for a deep, patient groove. Perfect for slow shuffles.

Try: Keep your wrist loose to maintain the swing feel.

#30 Minor Turnaround Blues

i7 - iv7 - bVI7 - V7

C: Cm7 - Fm7 - Ab7 - G7
G: Gm7 - Cm7 - Eb7 - D7

dark mysterious

A haunting minor blues that uses the flat six dominant for a dramatic pull back to i.

Try: Slide up to the bVI7 for a cry-like effect.

Jazz: 10 progressions

#31 Classic Two-Five-One
ii7 - V7 - Imaj7

C: Dm7 - G7 - Cmaj7
G: Am7 - D7 - Gmaj7

relaxed · romantic

The most important jazz move: tension on V7, release on Imaj7. Heard in nearly every standard.

Try: Voice each chord within three frets so the changes stay smooth.

#32 Turnaround
Imaj7 - vi7 - ii7 - V7

C: Cmaj7 - Am7 - Dm7 - G7
G: Gmaj7 - Em7 - Am7 - D7

nostalgic · playful

The standard turnaround that cycles back to the top of a tune. Smooth and swinging.

Try: Try walking the bass line between chords.

#33 Circle of Thirds
iii7 - vi7 - ii7 - V7

C: Em7 - Am7 - Dm7 - G7
G: Bm7 - Em7 - Am7 - D7

dreamy · warm

A descending chain of fifths leading home. Lush and flowing in ballad tempos.

Try: Keep common tones the same between chords.

#34 Major Resolution
ii7 - V7 - Imaj7 - IVmaj7

C: Dm7 - G7 - Cmaj7 - Fmaj7
G: Am7 - D7 - Gmaj7 - Cmaj7

relaxed · romantic

A two-five-one that moves on to the IVmaj7, giving a gentle lift after resolving.

Try: Emphasize the maj7 color on the last two chords.

#35 Rhythm Changes Turn
Imaj7 - VI7 - ii7 - V7

C: Cmaj7 - A7 - Dm7 - G7
G: Gmaj7 - E7 - Am7 - D7

playful · driving

The VI7 acts like a secondary dominant, adding a classic bebop twist to the turnaround.

Try: Swing eighth notes and accent the offbeat.

#36 Tritone Slide
ii7 - bII7 - Imaj7

C: Dm7 - Db7 - Cmaj7
G: Am7 - Ab7 - Gmaj7

mysterious · playful

Replacing V7 with bII7 creates a chromatic bass slide into the tonic. Sleek and modern.

Try: Notice the half-step slide in the bass note.

#37 Minor Jazz Loop
i7 - iv7 - bVII7 - bIIImaj7

C: Cm7 - Fm7 - Bb7 - Ebmaj7
G: Gm7 - Cm7 - F7 - Bbmaj7

dark · mysterious

A minor groove with a bVII7 pulling toward the relative major. Cool, nocturnal color.

Try: Play with soft fingertips for a smooth tone.

#38 Long Turnaround
Imaj7 - iii7 - vi7 - ii7 - V7

C: Cmaj7 - Em7 - Am7 - Dm7 - G7
G: Gmaj7 - Bm7 - Em7 - Am7 - D7

dreamy · nostalgic

A five-chord descent through the diatonic circle. Typical of ballads and swing.

Try: Count two beats for each chord to stay even.

#39 Subdominant Pivot

IVmaj7 - bVII7 - Imaj7

C: Fmaj7 - Bb7 - Cmaj7
G: Cmaj7 - F7 - Gmaj7

warm uplifting

A backdoor cadence resolving from bVII7 into the tonic. Warm and soulful.

Try: Compare it with ii V I to hear the difference.

#40 Extended Cycle

ii7 - V7 - iii7 - vi7 - ii7 - V7 - Imaj7

C: Dm7 - G7 - Em7 - Am7 - Dm7 - G7 - Cmaj7
G: Am7 - D7 - Bm7 - Em7 - Am7 - D7 - Gmaj7

relaxed romantic

Two ii V moves linked in a chain, wandering through the key before landing home.

Try: Practice in small segments and link them together.

Folk: 10 progressions

#41 Campfire Basics

I - IV - I - V

C: C - F - C - G
G: G - C - G - D

warm · nostalgic

The simplest folk loop: open, direct and ideal for singing around a fire.

Try: Use a steady bass-strum pattern: bass, strum, bass, strum.

#42 Rolling Hills

I - V - IV - V

C: C - G - F - G
G: G - D - C - D

relaxed · warm

A gentle rocking between V and IV gives an open, pastoral flavor.

Try: Alternate bass notes for a folk guitar feel.

#43 Home Stretch

I - IV - I - V - I

C: C - F - C - G - C
G: G - C - G - D - G

warm · nostalgic

Five chords that circle gently around the home chord. Familiar and comforting.

Try: Travis-style picking works beautifully here.

#44 Modal Wanderer

i - bVII - bIII - bVII

C: Cm - Bb - Eb - Bb
G: Gm - F - Bb - F

mysterious · melancholic

A modal minor progression found in Celtic and old-world ballads.

Try: Leave the third out of some chords for an open sound.

#45 Flat Seven Folk

I - bVII - I - IV

C: C - Bb - C - F
G: G - F - G - C

relaxed · playful

The flat seven adds a rustic, Mixolydian colour typical of folk dances.

Try: Keep the strum bouncy and loose.

#46 Walking Lift

I - ii - IV - V

C: C - Dm - F - G
G: G - Am - C - D

uplifting · playful

The ii chord adds a light touch before the climb to V. Cheerful and traveling.

Try: Mute lightly on the ii for a bright snap.

#47 Minor Opening

vi - I - IV - V

C: Am - C - F - G
G: Em - G - C - D

bittersweet · warm

Starts in a thoughtful minor and brightens up. A perfect storytelling progression.

Try: Use a slower strum for the vi and speed up on V.

#48 Five-Chord Verse

I - IV - I - IV - V

C: C - F - C - F - G
G: G - C - G - C - D

nostalgic · warm

Lets the home and subdominant sway before a V cadence. Typical of storytelling songs.

Try: Play simple arpeggios in the verse and strum the chorus.

#49 Mellow Drift

I - iii - vi - IV

C: C - Em - Am - F
G: G - Bm - Em - C

dreamy warm

A flowing descent through related chords, gentle and reflective.

Try: Use fingerstyle with thumb on bass notes.

#50 Suspended Hush

I - Isus4 - I - V

C: C - Csus4 - C - G
G: G - Gsus4 - G - D

dreamy relaxed

A hanging Isus4 gives the tonic a delicate shimmer before it resolves.

Try: Add the suspended fourth with your pinky for a smooth hammer-on.

Country: 10 progressions

#51 Honky-Tonk Basics

I - IV - V - I

C: C - F - G - C
G: G - C - D - G

playful · warm

Three chords and the truth. The foundation of honky-tonk and classic country.

Try: Use a boom-chick strum with alternating bass notes.

#52 Dirt Road

I - V - IV - I

C: C - G - F - C
G: G - D - C - G

relaxed · nostalgic

A laid-back country cruise that is easy to sing over.

Try: Play it with a steady open-chord strum.

#53 Front Porch

I - vi - ii - V

C: C - Am - Dm - G
G: G - Em - Am - D

nostalgic · romantic

A classic turnaround with a touch of ii. Smooth and sentimental.

Try: Use a gentle shuffle strum for the porch swing feel.

#54 Dominant Close

I - IV - I - V7

C: C - F - C - G7
G: G - C - G - D7

warm · playful

The V7 adds that slightly bluesy pull back to the tonic. Standard country closing.

Try: Hit a crisp downstroke on the V7 to set up the return.

#55 Highway Run

I - IV - bVII - I

C: C - F - Bb - C
G: G - C - F - G

driving · triumphant

The flat seven brings a modern country-rock edge.

Try: Palm mute the verse and open up on the chorus.

#56 Sad Fourth

I - I7 - IV - iv

C: C - C7 - F - Fm
G: G - G7 - C - Cm

bittersweet · melancholic

The minor iv chord after IV is a weeper: a tear-in-the-beer sound.

Try: Linger on the iv before returning to I.

#57 Secondary Twist

I - III7 - IV - V7

C: C - E7 - F - G7
G: G - B7 - C - D7

playful · warm

The III7 acts as a secondary dominant giving old-time Nashville flavor.

Try: Practice the III7 shape separately before linking.

#58 Five-Chord Chorus

I - IV - V - IV - I

C: C - F - G - F - C
G: G - C - D - C - G

uplifting · warm

A big singalong chorus that keeps coming home. Reliable and joyful.

Try: Strum with a clean, bright tone and plenty of open strings.

#59 Dance Hall

I - V7 - IV - I - V7

C: C - G7 - F - C - G7
G: G - D7 - C - G - D7

playful driving

A bouncy two-step progression for dancing.

Try: Keep a fast bass-strum rhythm with a strong backbeat.

#60 Modern Nashville

I - ii7 - IV - V7

C: C - Dm7 - F - G7
G: G - Am7 - C - D7

uplifting romantic

A polished radio-friendly sequence with a ii7 for extra warmth.

Try: Use a clean sound with light compression-style picking.

Soul and R&B: 10 progressions

#61 Smooth Maj7 Climb

Imaj7 - iii7 - IVmaj7 - V7

C: Cmaj7 - Em7 - Fmaj7 - G7
G: Gmaj7 - Bm7 - Cmaj7 - D7

romantic · warm

Silky chords that rise gently. A hallmark of smooth soul ballads.

Try: Use light, short strums on the upper strings.

#62 Classic Turnaround

ii7 - V7 - I - vi7

C: Dm7 - G7 - C - Am7
G: Am7 - D7 - G - Em7

nostalgic · romantic

A jazzy soul loop with a vi7 landing that keeps the cycle going.

Try: Let the voice-leading do the work; keep movements minimal.

#63 Gospel Descent

IVmaj7 - iii7 - ii7 - Imaj7

C: Fmaj7 - Em7 - Dm7 - Cmaj7
G: Cmaj7 - Bm7 - Am7 - Gmaj7

warm · uplifting

A stepwise descent to home with a gospel flavour. Rich and uplifting.

Try: Play thumb-on-bass with chord stabs on the upper strings.

#64 Motown Rise

vi7 - ii7 - V7 - Imaj7

C: Am7 - Dm7 - G7 - Cmaj7
G: Em7 - Am7 - D7 - Gmaj7

uplifting · playful

Circle of fifths motion with plenty of vintage soul charm.

Try: Add a syncopated stab on the offbeats.

#65 Soul Sweetener

I - iii7 - IV - V

C: C - Em7 - F - G
G: G - Bm7 - C - D

romantic · warm

The iii7 adds a sweet inner voice before the IV-V lift.

Try: Try a sixteenth-note strum with muted strings.

#66 Minor Groove

i7 - iv7 - i7 - V7

C: Cm7 - Fm7 - Cm7 - G7
G: Gm7 - Cm7 - Gm7 - D7

dark · romantic

A late-night minor loop. Cool, slinky and perfect for slow jams.

Try: Mute with your fretting hand for a tight rhythm.

#67 Rising Gospel

IVmaj7 - V - iii7 - vi7

C: Fmaj7 - G - Em7 - Am7
G: Cmaj7 - D - Bm7 - Em7

triumphant · uplifting

Climbs from the IV into V and falls into minor. Emotional and spiritual.

Try: Play bigger chords on the V for the lift.

#68 Borrowed Glow

Imaj7 - bIIImaj7 - IVmaj7 - V

C: Cmaj7 - Ebmaj7 - Fmaj7 - G
G: Gmaj7 - Bbmaj7 - Cmaj7 - D

dreamy · romantic

The borrowed bIII gives a surprising, cinematic colour in an R&B setting.

Try: Slide into the bIII from a fret below.

#69 Neo-Soul Float

vi7 - IVmaj7 - V - iii7

C: Am7 - Fmaj7 - G - Em7
G: Em7 - Cmaj7 - D - Bm7

dreamy | bittersweet

A relaxed, floating loop typical of modern neo-soul.

Try: Keep dynamics soft and strum behind the beat.

#70 Funk Nines

I9 - IV9 - I9 - V9

C: C9 - F9 - C9 - G9
G: G9 - C9 - G9 - D9

playful | driving

Dominant ninth chords give a funky, groove-first sound.

Try: Use sixteenth-note scratch strums with tight muting.

Reggae: 10 progressions

#71 One Drop Basics

I - IV - I - IV

C: C - F - C - F
G: G - C - G - C

relaxed warm

Two chords rocking gently. The skank on the offbeat is the whole point.

Try: Mute and chop on beats 2 and 4 for the skank.

#72 Island Sway

I - V - IV - IV

C: C - G - F - F
G: G - D - C - C

relaxed playful

A lilting pattern that stays on IV for a stretch, perfect for slow reggae.

Try: Keep the chop short and bouncy on the offbeats.

#73 Sunshine Cycle

ii - V - I - IV

C: Dm - G - C - F
G: Am - D - G - C

uplifting warm

A smooth ii V I resolving into IV. Sunny and optimistic.

Try: Play offbeat chops only; let the bass do the root.

#74 Minor Roots

i - iv - i - v

C: Cm - Fm - Cm - Gm
G: Gm - Cm - Gm - Dm

dark relaxed

A minor roots sound with a minor v. Heavy, hypnotic and spiritual.

Try: Use short upstroke chops high on the neck.

#75 Beach Float

I - iii - IV - IV

C: C - Em - F - F
G: G - Bm - C - C

dreamy relaxed

The iii softens the movement toward IV for a breezy, floating vibe.

Try: Add a light hi-hat style muted strum for flavour.

#76 Dub Echo

i - bVII - iv - i

C: Cm - Bb - Fm - Cm
G: Gm - F - Cm - Gm

mysterious dark

A minor dub-style loop with a bVII passing chord. Deep and echoing.

Try: Leave lots of space and let the bass lead.

#77 Pop Reggae

I - IV - vi - IV

C: C - F - Am - F
G: G - C - Em - C

playful warm

A bright cycle often used for radio-friendly reggae.

Try: Chop on the upbeats with a clean, bright tone.

#78 Flat Seven Roots

I - bVII - IV - IV

C: C - Bb - F - F
G: G - F - C - C

relaxed nostalgic

A mixolydian flavour with a roots-reggae feel.

Try: Hold the IV for two bars to build the groove.

#79 Minor Lift

vi - IV - I - IV

C: Am - F - C - F
G: Em - C - G - C

bittersweet relaxed

A sweet minor start that lifts into major and rocks between I and IV.

Try: Keep the upstroke chop light and loose.

#80 Lovers Rock

I - vi - I - IV - V

C: C - Am - C - F - G
G: G - Em - G - C - D

romantic warm

Smooth and romantic with a touch of soul. Typical of lovers rock.

Try: Use a gentle offbeat strum and let the vocal breathe.

Latin: 10 progressions

#81 Andalusian Cadence

i - bVII - bVI - V

C: Cm - Bb - Ab - G
G: Gm - F - Eb - D

dark romantic

The famous Spanish descent ending on a major V. Passionate and dramatic.

Try: Use rasgueado strums and accent the V.

#82 Flamenco Close

i - iv - V7 - i

C: Cm - Fm - G7 - Cm
G: Gm - Cm - D7 - Gm

dark tense

A simple minor cadence full of tension and release. Classic Spanish colour.

Try: Strum with confident downstrokes and quick rolls.

#83 Dominant Andalusian

i - bVII - bVI - V7

C: Cm - Bb - Ab - G7
G: Gm - F - Eb - D7

tense romantic

The V7 gives the Andalusian cadence extra pull back to i.

Try: Hit the V7 with a sharp accent before returning.

#84 Bossa Slide

Imaj7 - ii7 - bII7 - Imaj7

C: Cmaj7 - Dm7 - Db7 - Cmaj7
G: Gmaj7 - Am7 - Ab7 - Gmaj7

relaxed dreamy

A smooth chromatic slide characteristic of bossa nova.

Try: Use thumb on bass and fingers on the upper strings.

#85 Son Cubano

I - IV - V7 - IV

C: C - F - G7 - F
G: G - C - D7 - C

playful driving

A bright, danceable cycle used in Cuban son.

Try: Keep a syncopated strum with accents on the offbeat.

#86 Minor Bolero

i - bVI - bVII - i

C: Cm - Ab - Bb - Cm
G: Gm - Eb - F - Gm

romantic melancholic

A passionate minor lament with a rising bVII pull.

Try: Play slowly and let each chord sustain.

#87 Salsa Cycle

i - iv - bVII - V7

C: Cm - Fm - Bb - G7
G: Gm - Cm - F - D7

driving tense

A powerful minor loop typical of salsa. Fiery and rhythmic.

Try: Practice a steady clave rhythm with your strumming hand.

#88 Bolero Warmth

I - vi - ii7 - V7

C: C - Am - Dm7 - G7
G: G - Em - Am7 - D7

romantic warm

A smooth bolero-style turnaround with warm sevenths.

Try: Use a gentle bolero rhythm: long, short, short.

#89 Phrygian Fire

i - bII - bVII - i

C: Cm - Db - Bb - Cm
G: Gm - Ab - F - Gm

mysterious dark

The bII gives a Phrygian flavour that is unmistakably Spanish.

Try: Try tremolo picking on the bII for drama.

#90 Minor Fifth Loop

i - v - bVI - V

C: Cm - Gm - Ab - G
G: Gm - Dm - Eb - D

mysterious tense

A hypnotic minor loop that includes both minor and major fifth chords.

Try: Play the transition from bVI to V cleanly and quickly.

Ballads: 10 progressions

#91 Canon Cycle

I - V - vi - iii - IV - I - IV - V

C: C - G - Am - Em - F - C - F - G
G: G - D - Em - Bm - C - G - C - D

romantic · nostalgic

The long, flowing cycle that stretches over eight bars. Stately and moving.

Try: Fingerpick in a slow eighth-note pattern.

#92 Ballad Add9

Iadd9 - vi - IV - V

C: Cadd9 - Am - F - G
G: Gadd9 - Em - C - D

romantic · warm

Open add9 chords lend a soft glow to a tender ballad.

Try: Play gentle arpeggios and let all strings ring.

#93 Slow Burn Minor

vi - IV - I - V - vi - IV - V

C: Am - F - C - G - Am - F - G
G: Em - C - G - D - Em - C - D

melancholic · bittersweet

A seven-chord cycle that builds in emotion toward the final V.

Try: Increase dynamics slowly across the cycle.

#94 Heartfelt Verse

I - IV - I - V - vi - IV

C: C - F - C - G - Am - F
G: G - C - G - D - Em - C

warm · nostalgic

A longer verse that settles at home before moving to the relative minor.

Try: Use a soft fingerstyle pick pattern.

#95 Maj7 Descent

IVmaj7 - iii7 - vi7 - Vsus4 - V

C: Fmaj7 - Em7 - Am7 - Gsus4 - G
G: Cmaj7 - Bm7 - Em7 - Dsus4 - D

dreamy · romantic

A lush chain ending with a sus4 resolving into V. Cinematic and smooth.

Try: Release the sus4 on the last beat for tension.

#96 Tearful Subdominant

I - I7 - IV - iv - I

C: C - C7 - F - Fm - C
G: G - G7 - C - Cm - G

melancholic · bittersweet

The minor iv brings a sudden shadow before resolving back home.

Try: Slow the strum to let the iv chord land.

#97 Minor Sorrow

i - bVI - iv - V

C: Cm - Ab - Fm - G
G: Gm - Eb - Cm - D

melancholic · dark

A heartfelt minor ballad progression ending on a major V.

Try: Use dynamics to emphasize the final V.

#98 Wedding Walk

I - iii - vi - IV - ii - V

C: C - Em - Am - F - Dm - G
G: G - Bm - Em - C - Am - D

romantic · triumphant

A graceful six-chord walk with lots of movement and resolution.

Try: Practice slowly and aim for even chord changes.

#99 Anthem Build

I - V - vi - IV - I - V - IV

C: C - G - Am - F - C - G - F
G: G - D - Em - C - G - D - C

triumphant uplifting

Extends the familiar four-chord loop to a seven-chord anthem.

Try: Strum louder with each repeat to build emotion.

#100 Memory Lane

vi - iii - IV - I - ii - V

C: Am - Em - F - C - Dm - G
G: Em - Bm - C - G - Am - D

nostalgic melancholic

A gentle cascade of relative chords that feels like looking back.

Try: Keep the tempo slow and let each chord breathe.

Index by mood

Bittersweet

#2 Minor Start Lift; #26 Slow Burn Blues; #47 Minor Opening; #56 Sad Fourth; #69 Neo-Soul Float; #79 Minor Lift; #93 Slow Burn Minor; #96 Tearful Subdominant

Dark

#13 Dark Descent; #15 Epic Minor Climb; #18 Minor Fourth Edge; #23 Minor Twelve-Bar; #30 Minor Turnaround Blues; #37 Minor Jazz Loop; #66 Minor Groove; #74 Minor Roots; #76 Dub Echo; #81 Andalusian Cadence; #82 Flamenco Close; #89 Phrygian Fire; #97 Minor Sorrow

Dreamy

#7 Five-Chord Flow; #9 Maj7 Shimmer; #10 Open Add9 Glow; #33 Circle of Thirds; #38 Long Turnaround; #49 Mellow Drift; #50 Suspended Hush; #68 Borrowed Glow; #69 Neo-Soul Float; #75 Beach Float; #84 Bossa Slide; #95 Maj7 Descent

Driving

#8 Minor Lean; #11 Mixolydian Drive; #12 Three-Chord Stomp; #13 Dark Descent; #14 Major-Third Crunch; #16 Simple Slam; #17 Flat Seven Swagger; #19 Rock Ladder; #20 Double Flat Lift; #21 Quick Skeleton; #22 Quick-Change Twelve-Bar; #25 Three-Chord Boogie; #35 Rhythm Changes Turn; #55 Highway Run; #59 Dance Hall; #70 Funk Nines; #85 Son Cubano; #87 Salsa Cycle

Melancholic

#8 Minor Lean; #23 Minor Twelve-Bar; #44 Modal Wanderer; #56 Sad Fourth; #86 Minor Bolero; #93 Slow Burn Minor; #96 Tearful Subdominant; #97 Minor Sorrow; #100 Memory Lane

Mysterious

#18 Minor Fourth Edge; #30 Minor Turnaround Blues; #36 Tritone Slide; #37 Minor Jazz Loop; #44 Modal Wanderer; #76 Dub Echo; #89 Phrygian Fire; #90 Minor Fifth Loop

Nostalgic

#1 The Four-Chord Anthem; #3 Fifties Turnaround; #7 Five-Chord Flow; #28 Eight-Bar Blues; #32 Turnaround; #38 Long Turnaround; #41 Campfire Basics; #43 Home Stretch; #48 Five-Chord Verse; #52 Dirt Road; #53 Front Porch; #62 Classic Turnaround; #78 Flat Seven Roots; #91 Canon Cycle; #94 Heartfelt Verse; #100 Memory Lane

Playful

#5 Sunny Walk-Up; #12 Three-Chord Stomp; #16 Simple Slam; #25 Three-Chord Boogie; #27 Jazz Blues Form; #32 Turnaround; #35 Rhythm Changes Turn; #36 Tritone Slide; #45 Flat Seven Folk; #46 Walking Lift; #51 Honky-Tonk Basics; #54 Dominant Close; #57 Secondary Twist; #59 Dance Hall; #64 Motown Rise; #70 Funk Nines; #72 Island Sway; #77 Pop Reggae; #85 Son Cubano

Relaxed

#17 Flat Seven Swagger; #21 Quick Skeleton; #24 Short Form; #26 Slow Burn Blues; #28 Eight-Bar Blues; #29 Slow Shuffle Twelve; #31 Classic Two-Five-One; #34 Major Resolution; #40 Extended Cycle; #42 Rolling Hills; #45 Flat Seven Folk; #50 Suspended Hush; #52 Dirt Road; #71 One Drop Basics; #72 Island Sway; #74 Minor Roots; #75 Beach Float; #78 Flat Seven Roots; #79 Minor Lift; #84 Bossa Slide

Romantic

#4 Gentle Climb; #9 Maj7 Shimmer; #31 Classic Two-Five-One; #34 Major Resolution; #40 Extended Cycle; #53 Front Porch; #60 Modern Nashville; #61 Smooth Maj7 Climb; #62 Classic Turnaround; #65 Soul Sweetener; #66 Minor Groove; #68 Borrowed Glow; #80 Lovers Rock; #81 Andalusian Cadence; #83 Dominant Andalusian; #86 Minor Bolero; #88 Bolero Warmth; #91 Canon Cycle; #92 Ballad Add9; #95 Maj7 Descent; #98 Wedding Walk

Tense

#82 Flamenco Close; #83 Dominant Andalusian; #87 Salsa Cycle; #90 Minor Fifth Loop

Triumphant

#6 Chorus Opener; #11 Mixolydian Drive; #14 Major-Third Crunch; #15 Epic Minor Climb; #20 Double Flat Lift; #55 Highway Run; #67 Rising Gospel; #98 Wedding Walk; #99 Anthem Build

Uplifting

#1 The Four-Chord Anthem; #2 Minor Start Lift; #5 Sunny Walk-Up; #6 Chorus Opener; #39 Subdominant Pivot; #46 Walking Lift; #58 Five-Chord Chorus; #60 Modern Nashville; #63 Gospel Descent; #64 Motown Rise; #67 Rising Gospel; #73 Sunshine Cycle; #99 Anthem Build

Warm

#3 Fifties Turnaround; #4 Gentle Climb; #10 Open Add9 Glow; #19 Rock Ladder; #22 Quick-Change Twelve-Bar; #24 Short Form; #27 Jazz Blues Form; #29 Slow Shuffle Twelve; #33 Circle of Thirds; #39 Subdominant Pivot; #41 Campfire Basics; #42 Rolling Hills; #43 Home Stretch; #47 Minor Opening; #48 Five-Chord Verse; #49 Mellow Drift; #51 Honky-Tonk Basics; #54 Dominant Close; #57 Secondary Twist; #58 Five-Chord Chorus; #61 Smooth Maj7 Climb; #63 Gospel Descent; #65 Soul Sweetener; #71 One

Drop Basics; #73 Sunshine Cycle; #77 Pop Reggae; #80 Lovers Rock; #88 Bolero Warmth; #92 Ballad Add9; #94 Heartfelt Verse

Next step

Choose one genre, play its ten progressions in C, then play your favorite three in G. Write one new progression of your own using the same numerals.